Mojgan Samandar A. E. Ph.D.

Toronto, Ontario, Canada
mojgan.samandar@outlook.com
https://samandarali.github.io/
https://www.linkedin.com/in/mojgan-samandar/

Dynamic and results driven Economist with over five years of experience in economic research, policy evaluation, and advanced statistical analysis. Expertise in interpreting complex macroeconomic trends and financial market data to provide actionable insights for informed decision making. Proficient in managing and analyzing large datasets, employing data visualization, econometric modeling, and machine learning techniques such as time series analysis and forecasting. Strong communication, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills, with a proven track record of collaborating across teams to deliver impactful research and strategic recommendations.

Skills

Data Techniques	Predictive Modeling, Econometrics, Data Visualization, Machine Learning, Web Scraping, Scientometrics, Bibliometrics, Focus Group, Survey, Case Studies, Narrative & Systematic Literature Review
Software	R/R Studio, Shiny, Python, Sci2, Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint), Power BI, Tableau, Stata, EViews, MS SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Cassandra, Git, GitHub
Soft Skills	Analytical and Critical Thinking, Interpersonal Skills, Communication Skills, Organizational Skills
Languages	English (Fluent), French (Beginner), Persian (Native)

Professional Experience

Nov 2018 – Dec 2022 **Research Faculty Member**, National Research Institute for Science Policy (NRISP), Tehran, Iran

- Led multiple research projects on policy evaluation and innovation strategy.
- Conducted impact assessments, costbenefit analyses, and policy evaluations using econometrics and data analytics.
  Collaborated with government ministries to provide datadriven advisory services and recommendations.
- Authored nine policy reports that influenced national policy formulation.

Nov 2020 – Nov 2021 **Head of Department,** Department of STI Monitoring, National Research Institute for Science Policy(NRISP), Tehran, Iran

- Redefined the department's mission and strategies.
- Contributed to strategic decisionmaking as part of the institution's Central Council.
- Played a key role in restructuring NRISP's research groups in 2020.

2017–2018 **Postdoctoral Researcher,** Iran's National Elites Foundation, Al.Zahra University, Tehran, Iran

- Designed protocols for new projects, collected data from multiple sources and reviewed existing literature.
- Participated actively in workshops organized by the department or external organizations related to research topics.
- Generated innovative solutions to resolve research-related problems

Sep 2018 – Mar 2019 **Market Research Analyst** (Economic Expert), Jofreh United Industries Company, Tehran, Iran

- Conducted market research to assess economic trends and forecast product demand.
- Evaluated pricing strategies and market competition through regression analysis.
- Analyzed customer datasets to optimize marketing initiatives.

Academic Teaching Experience

2021-2022

PhD Level

"Fundamentals of Classical and Neoclassical Economists and New Theorists on Technology Development", PhD students of Management of Technology, Allame Tabatabai University, Tehran, Iran.

International Level

"Consumer and Innovation", international students, international Business Winter School, AmirKabir University of technology.

2020-2021

Master Level

"Economics of Innovation", MBA students, AmirKabir University, Tehran, Iran.

2019-2020

Master Level

"Economics of Innovation", MBA students, AmirKabir University, Tehran, Iran.

PhD Level

"Fundamentals of Classical and Neoclassical Economists and New Theorists on Technology Development", PhD students of Management of Technology, Allame Tabatabai University, Tehran, Iran.

2018-2019

PhD Level

"Fundamentals of Classical and Neoclassical Economists and New Theorists on Technology Development", PhD students of Management of Technology, Allame Tabatabai University, Tehran, Iran.

Master Level

2404528_02, "**Principle of Economics"**, MBA students, Allame Tabatabai University, Tehran, Iran.
2404528_04, **"Principle of Economics"**, MBA students, Allame Tabatabai University, Tehran, Iran.

2017-2018

Bachelor level

"**Principal of Economics"**, Mathematics and Computer science students, Al. Zhara University, Tehran, Iran.

2016-2017

Expert Level

"The role of technology in management policies of the day", expertise in Iranian National Standards Organization (INSO), Karaj, Iran.

2012-2013

Bachelor level

"Principles of Economics", Bachelor students of Management, Jame Elmi Karbordi University (Charm Branch), Tehran, Iran

Education

May 2024 **M.Sc. in Big Data Analytics**, Trent University, Peterborough, Canada| GPA: 91.33
Project: Labor Market Landscape for Economics Graduates in Canada

May 2015 **Ph.D. in Economics,** Scuola Superiore Sant'Anna di Pisa, Pisa, Italy

Thesis: Essays in Economics of Innovation

May 2011 **M.Sc. in Industrial Economics,** Gothenburg University, Gothenburg, Sweden| GPA: 95
Thesis: Corporate Governance and Default Risk

Certifications

Jan 2011	**Adapting Behavior in a Fundamentally Uncertain World**, IMPRS Uncertainty School, Max Planck Institute of Economics, Jena, Germany
Jan 2012	**Time Series Analysis**, CIDE (Interuniversity Centre of Econometrics), University of Torino, Bertinoro, Italy
Apr 2022	**Advanced Patent Course**, WIPO
Mar 2022	**Specialized Course on the Essentials of Patents**, WIPO

Selected Publications

Book Chapters

- Molazade, **M Samandar Ali Eshtehardi, M.,** Hafezi, R.; (2024) Sustainable Fashion and Circular Economy: Historical Trends and Future Orientations. In A. Stefanakis, & K. Tsagarakis, Circular Economy and Sustainable Development: a necessary nexus for a sustainable future, *Springer*. https://link.springer.com/book/9783031660061#about-this-book.

Published Papers

1. **Samandar Ali Eshtehardi, M.**, Labour Market Landscape for Economics Graduates in Canada, Canadian Public Policy, Forthcomming March 2024.
2. Ghadimi, A., **Samnadar Ali Eshtehardi, M.**, Saviz, M., Mahdad, M., (2023) Grassroots Innovations and innovators: the case of Iran*, Journal of Innovation and Development*, 1-24. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1080/2157930X.2023.2233208
3. **Samadnar Ali Eshtehardi, M.**, (2022) Structural-interpretative modelling of strategies for achieving the mission of education in an entrepreneurial and community-oriented university, *Quarterly Journal of Research and Planning in Higher Education,* 28(3), 33-64. (In Persian) DOI: 10.52547/IRPHE.28.2.33.
4. Janavi, E., Mansourzadeh, M. J., **Samnadar Ali Eshtehardi, M.**, (2020). A methodology for developing scientific diversification strategy of countries. *Scientometrics*, 1-36. DOI: 10.1007/s11192-020-03685-1
5. Bagheri, S.; Raoufi, P.; **Samnadar Ali Eshtehardi, M.**; Shaverdy, S.; Ramezani, B. & Mardani, A. (2018) Using the crowd for business model innovation: the case of Digikala, *The journal of R&D Management*. 50(1), 3-17. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/radm.12353
6. **Samnadar Ali Eshtehardi, M.**, Bagheri, S.K. & Di Minin, A. (2016). Regional Innovative Behaviour: Evidence from Iran, *Technological Forecasting & Social Change Journal*. 122, 128-148 DOI:10.1016/J.TECHFORE.2016.02.011

Working Paper

- **Samnadar Ali Eshtehardi, M.** & Bagheri, S.K. Gender Gap in Patenting Activities: Evidence from Iran (No. 2015/22), Laboratory of Economics and Management (LEM), Sant'Anna School of Advanced Studies, Pisa, Italy, 2015. URL: https://www.econstor.eu/handle/10419/119866

Funded Projects

2020-2021 **Educational Strategies for Entrepreneurial Universities**
Supported by the Ministry of Science, Research and Technology
Role: Principal Investigator

Skills: The Interpretive Structural Modeling (ISM), focus group analysis, framework synthesis, R, Excel, Survey Design, Educational Policy Assessment

2018-2019 **Means to Improve Iran's National Innovation System Efficiency**
Supported by the National Research Institute for Science Policy (NRISP)
Role: Main Researcher
Skills: R, STATA, Data Envelopment Analysis (DEA), Tobit Model Analysis, Statistical Reporting

2019-2020 **Identifying Iran's Knowledge Frontier Products**
Supported by NRISP
Role: Main Researcher
Skills: Economic Complexity Analysis, R Programming, Data Analysis, Comparative Economic Studies, Statistical Reporting

2017-2018 **Research Core on Equitable Share of Production Factors in the Iranian Economy**
Supported by the Social Security Organization Research Institute.
Role: Main Researcher
Skills: R Programming, Data Collection Techniques, Economic Equity Analysis, Policy Research

2016 **Report on Digital Economy Performance and Its Prospects in the World**
Supported by the Ministry of Information and Communications Technology of Iran.
Role: Main Researcher
Skills: Stata, R Programming, Data Collection and Analysis, Digital Economy Assessment, Policy Recommendation

Awards

- Postdoctoral Fellowship, National Elites Foundation, Iran, 2017–2018
- Best Paper Award, 5th International Conference on Management of Technology, Tehran, 2015
- Full Ph.D. Scholarship, Sant'Anna School of Advanced Studies, Italy, 2011–2014
- Erasmus Scholarship, Sant'Anna School of Advanced Studies, Italy, 2014

Workshop and Seminar Design

- Workshop on Scientometrics & Bibliometrics in Social Science, 2nd June 2022, Business Management and organization group, Wageningen University, Wageningen, Netherlands.
- A series of seminars on "Entrepreneurial University: form theory to practice", 24 September 2019, 15 January 2019, 23 January 2021, 27 January 2021, 17 February 2021, 3 March 2021, National Research Institute for Science Policy (NRISP).
- A Seminar on Strategies to fulfil Entrepreneurial education mission, 10 October 2021, National Research Institute for Science Policy (NRISP).
- A Workshop on Systematic literature search, 13 March 2022, AmirKabir University, Tehran, Iran.
- A Seminar on Policies to increase economic efficiency in Iran's national innovation system, 26 August 2020, National Research Institute for Science Policy (NRISP).
- Workshop on Intellectual Property Game for the age group of 912 years, From 10 to 14 of November 2019, National Research Institute for Science Policy (NRISP).